

History of Emergence of Bangladesh.

GEHE-3601

Q-1: Introduction of Bangladesh to mention its boundaries and area.

Answer: ①

Bangladesh is an independent and sovereign state located in South Asia. Emerging as a free nation in 1971 after a bloody Liberation war. It is geographically the largest delta in the world. Short introduction of Bangladesh is given below:-

1. Name:

The official name of the country is People's Republic of Bangladesh.

2. Location:-

Bangladesh is situated in the north-eastern part of South Asia. It acts as a land bridge between South Asia and Southeast Asia.

① Mathematical location:

It extends from $20^{\circ}34'$ to $26^{\circ}38'$ North latitude and from $88^{\circ}01'$ to $92^{\circ}41'$ East longitude.

① Tropic of Cancer:-

The Tropic of Cancer 23.5° North passes almost right through the middle of the country, giving it a tropical monsoon climate.

3. Area:-

Despite its massive population, Bangladesh has a relatively small landmass.

① Standard total Area:-

The officially recognized total area of Bangladesh is 1,47,570 square Kilometers / 56977 square miles.

*Note on updated area:-

Following the historic Land Boundary Agreement

(Exchange of enclaves) in 2015, Bangladesh gained a net area about of 40 sq, making the revised area approximately 1,47,610 sq. Km.

③ Land vs. Water:—

Out of the total area, vast river network, Haors, baors, and lakes cover roughly 9405 sq km.

④ Forest Area:

The largest mangrove forest in the world the Sundarbans covers an area of about 6017 sq. Km.

④ Boundaries of Bangladesh:—

The total length of Bangladesh's border is approximately 5138 Kilometers. The specific boundaries are as follows:—

① North:

The country is bounded by the Indian states of West Bengal, Meghalaya and Assam.

② West :-

It is bounded entirely by the Indian state of West Bengal.

③ East :

It is shared with the Indian states of Assam, Tripura, Mizoram, as well as a border with Myanmar (the Chin & Rakhine states).

④ South :-

It's formed by the Bay of Bengal.

* Breakdown of border lengths:-

① Border with India approximately 4156 Km.

② Border with Myanmar approximately 271 Km

③ Coastline approximately 711 Km.

⑤ Maritime boundaries:-

Following the historic verdicts by the ITLOS ~~and~~ against Myanmar in 2012 and the PCA against India in 2014, Bangladesh established sovereign rights over a vast maritime area in the Bay of Bengal:—

○ Territorial Water: 12 nautical miles.

○ Contiguous Zone: 24 " "

○ Exclusive Economic Zone: 200 " "

○ Continental shelf: 354 " "

○ Total Sea Area: 1,18,813 sq. Km:

⊛ In summary, Bangladesh is a small area but strategically significant country in South Asia.

Add/Draw Map

-2No: sketch the ^{Physio}geographical feature of Bd.

And explain the geographical impacts on ~~the~~ the life and society of the country. (5+5)m

** Answer **

According to geological formation, age and topographical features, the physiography of Bd. is divided into three major regions:-

① Tertiary Hills (Approx. 12% of total area):-

○ Formation age: These hills were formed about from 660 million years ago to 2 million years ago during the tertiary period.

○ South-eastern Hills:

Chattogram, Ctg hill tracts (Rangomati, Bandarban, Khagrachari) and Cox's bazar. The average height is 610 m. The highest peaks Tajingdong's height is 1231 m.

→ North-eastern Hills:-

Located in Sylhet, Moulvibazar and Habiganj.

Their height generally ranges from 30-90 m.

② Pleistocene Terraces (Approx: 8% of total area):-

→ Formation age:

These landmasses were formed ^{from} 2 million years to 25,000 years ago during the Pleistocene epoch.

→ The Barind Tract:

Rajshahi, Naogaon, Bogura, Dinajpur. It's elevated about 6-12 m (Location: North-Western)

→ The Madhupur and Bhawal Tract: -

Located in the central region (Tangail, Mymensingh, Gazipur). It's average height is about 30 m.

→ The Lalmai Hills:-

Located in the Cumilla district. It's average

height is about 21 m.

③ Recent Flooded plains land (Approx. 80%); —

→ Formation age: From 25000 years ago to the present day.

The land is incredibly flat extremely fertile. It includes the Piedmont plains, Meghna estuarine, the Ganges, the Sylhet Basin, the coastal floodplains.

* Impact of Geographical features on the life of Bd. people *

The impacts are explained below: —

① Agrarian Economy and Occupation: —

Because of 80% fertile recent floodplains, It receives heavy monsoon rainfall, so the primary occupation of the people is agriculture.

② Impact on Food habits:-

Geography ~~and~~ directly dictates the Bengali diet.

The vast network of rivers, haors and flatlands provides an abundance of fish and rice.

There is a proverb, "Mache - Bhate Bangali."

③ Housing & Settlement:-

→ In the Plains Due to heavy rainfall and annual floods rural houses traditionally built on raised earthen mounds.

→ In the hills, In the tertiary hills regions tribal communities built houses on raised bamboo stilts. to protect themselves from wild animals, dampness.

④ Dress and Clothing:-

The geographical location of Bd. creates

a tropical monsoon climate characterized by hot weather for most of the year.

So, society prefers light, loose, cotton clothes.

⑤ Cultural Development :—

The riverine landscape has profoundly enriched the literature, folklore, and music of the country. Famous folk songs like Bhatiali, Bhawaiya, Sari Gaan are inspired by river life.

On the other hand, Geographical hazards — cyclones, river erosion, flood — has made the people hardworking, brave, deeply spiritual.

Q. NO: sketch the river system of Bd. How can maximize the use of river resources for sustainable development ... (20m)

* Answer *

Bangladesh is widely known as the, "the land of rivers". The country features over 700 rivers. The river system is sketched into four major networks: —

① Brahmaputra - Jamuna River system: —

It originates ^{from Manas Sarovar lake} in Tibet and enters Bd. ^{* through the Khasi hills} as the Brahmaputra. It is called Jamuna after merging with the Teesta River flowing southward to meet the Padma at Goalando.

② Ganges - Padma River system: —

The Ganges originates ^{from Gangotri glacier in the Himalayas} in India and enters Bd. as the Padma. After joining the Jamuna

river, the combined massive flow ^{further} continues southeast named Padma to meet the Meghna system at Aricha.

③ ~~Surma~~ ^{The} Meghna River System:-

It originates in the Naga-Manipur hills India and enters the Sylhet dividing into the Surma and Khushiyara River. Meghna is the deepest and widest river of Bd. meeting the Padma at Chandpur. And combined flow falls in the Bay of Bengal.

④ Chattogram Region River System:-

These originate from Ctg Hill Tracts and Lushi Hills and rapidly flow into the Bay of Bengal. Karnaphuli, the most important river (320 km long) originates from Lushai Hills.

Sangu, Feni, Halda other rivers. of Ctg.

* Maximizing the use of River Resource:—

① Irrigation for Agriculture:—

Rivers provide essential freshwater for farming. We should proper use of river for dry-season farming building dams and barrages. This saves underground water and protect the environment.

② Improving water Transport:—

Waterways are a cheap and eco-friendly way to travel and trade. Regular dredging is needed to keep rivers deep and navigable all year round.

③ Protecting fisheries:—

Rivers give fishes and jobs for millions of

rural people. To protect it, we must stop overfishing, ban the catching of baby fish and create safe fish sanctuaries.

④ stopping pollution and making power :-

Factories must use water treatment plants to keep river water clean and safe from toxic chemicals. At the same time, fast-flowing river Karnaphuli should be used to generate eco-friendly hydro-electricity.